



VIRTUAL SERVERS

When a few thousand users are logged onto ThinkDigit's website or forum, the true advantages of a cloud hosting setup kicks in. During this scenario, the website is hosted and served from various virtual servers. Basically multiple instances of the website are created across multiple servers which are connected through the cloud hosting setup.



LOAD BALANCING SYSTEM

This is a critical component of the cloud hosting setup. A load balancing system ensures that no server is overloaded and that the end-user can continue accessing the website transparently.

The load balancer is an intermediary between the numerous open connections requesting access to the website that is being served from different servers simultaneously.



CLOUD HOSTING SETUPS

Unlike conventional dedicated or shared website hosting, where you pay a fixed monthly or yearly subscription fee, cloud hosting operates a little differently. Services such as Amazon Web Services and Google AppEngine, charge based on the instance of a website, amount of storage used, bandwidth used etc, each being billed separately.